



TIPS & TRICKS



Email your MySQL query results

Here is a simple trick that can be useful if you run some long-lasting MySQL query and want to get informed as soon as it is finished. This works on the MySQL client level.

The trick is to use the *pager* directive to redirect the output to a mail program instead of displaying it on standard output. Log in to *mysql* and type the following command:

```
mysql> pager mail -s "subject" yourname@yourdomain.com
```

```
PAGER set to 'mail -s "subject" yourname@yourdomain.com'
```

The above will redirect the output to *yourname@yourdomain.com* and the subject for the email received will be *subject*.

After setting *pager*, change the database and run the query. The result of the query will be mailed to your email ID. Given below is an example:

```
mysql> select count(*) from feed where ext_key like 'a%';
```

```
1 row in set (10 min 35.88 sec)
```

The result of running the above query is emailed to you instead of being displayed on the screen.

—**Mohana Sundaram Natarajan**,
mohanasundaram@consim.com



Install this interactive command line file manager

Midnight commander is a powerful and interactive command line file manager. In RHEL, you can install it using the Yum *install mc* command. You can start by issuing the *mc* command from the command line. Here you will see a tree structured directory and file listing. At the bottom, you can see a number of options to perform various file and directory related tasks. You can perform

an operation using the corresponding function key. For example, to get help, press F1 and to quit, press F10. So, try out this cool utility.

—**Vinayak Pandey**,
vinayakpandeyit@gmail.com



The next available UID

Here is one way to find out the next available UID on a system. It takes both the password and group files, and finds the next available UID and displays it. Let's first create a text file, named *myscript.sh*, with the following commands:

```
#!/bin/bash
awk -F":" '{ print $3 }' /etc/passwd > number_list
awk -F":" '{ print $3 }' /etc/group >> number_list
A=`sort -g number_list | tail -1`
A=`expr $A + 1`
echo "New Available UID is $A"
```

Now let's run the script *myscript.sh* as follows:

```
%sh myscript.sh
```

The new available UID is 65535.

—**Tanaji Yadav**,
tanajiyadav@hotmail.com



Check the Web server status with telnet

If you want to check whether the Web server is running or not, but don't have access to any browsers (lynx, IE, Netscape ...) to do so, here is a simple solution. Just telnet to that machine on the *http* port (port no 80, in general) and look out for the output:

```
% telnet <ip addr> <port no>
```

And then, say 'get /' (without quotes). If the Web server is running, it displays the HTML script of the homepage or the basic information, and closes the connection to the remote host: